

Catholic Mass Etiquette Guide

This guide is intended to help parishioners and visitors understand the appropriate dress and behavior expected during the celebration of the Holy Mass in the Catholic Church. Following these guidelines reflects reverence for the sacred liturgy and respect for others.

■ Dress Code

- 1 Wear modest, clean, and respectful clothing.
- 2 Men should remove hats or caps upon entering the church.
- 3 Women may choose to wear a chapel veil or mantilla (optional, but traditional).
- 4 Avoid shorts, tank tops, mini skirts, or clothing with inappropriate slogans.
- 5 Dress shoes or sandals are preferred; avoid flip-flops or athletic wear.

■ Behavior and Reverence

- 1 Arrive on time and remain until the final blessing and dismissal.
- 2 Maintain a prayerful and respectful silence in the sanctuary.
- 3 Participate in prayers, hymns, and responses as appropriate.
- 4 Turn off or silence all electronic devices.
- 5 Avoid eating, chewing gum, or drinking inside the church (except water if medically necessary).

† ■ Receiving Holy Communion

- 1 Only baptized Catholics in a state of grace should receive Communion.
- 2 Fast for at least one hour before receiving the Eucharist (water and medicine permitted).
- 3 Approach reverently, bow before receiving, and respond 'Amen' clearly.
- 4 Receive either on the tongue or in the hand, as is your custom or diocesan norm.

■ ■ After Mass

- 1 Remain for the closing hymn and final blessing.
- 2 Leave the church quietly, allowing others to pray.
- 3 Consider praying a thanksgiving prayer or making a short visit to the Blessed Sacrament.
- 4 Socialize only after leaving the sacred space.